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Boss is Always Right? (Nah, Not Always)

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



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Ever heard that old saying, “The boss is always right”? Honestly, if you’ve been around the block a few times, you know that’s just not how it works.

I’ve had all sorts of bosses in my career. Some were awesome, some were... well, let’s just say they taught me a lot about patience. But every single one left me with a lesson.

Here are the **5 types of bosses** I’ve bumped into (and what I figured out about dealing with them):

Type 1: The “Only the Best” Boss This boss wants perfection. Every little thing has to be just right. They’ll push you hard, and sometimes it feels like you’re running a marathon at top speed. But here’s the thing: if you can hang in there, you’ll learn so much. I remember those late nights, getting feedback that felt tough. But looking back, that’s where I really grew.

My tip: Don’t take it personally. Just learn. When they finally say “good job,” it means something.

Type 2: The “Mood Swing” Boss One day, they’re super happy with you. The next, you’re wondering what you did wrong. Their feelings can change the whole vibe of the office. I used to try to figure out their moods, but it was exhausting.

My tip: Don't get caught up in their drama. Do your work, keep your cool, and don't let their bad day ruin yours.

Type 3: The "Always Changing" Boss This boss is a whirlwind. New ideas pop up daily, priorities shift, and what was urgent yesterday is forgotten today. It's never boring, but it can be a bit wild. I learned to just roll with it and keep my own goals clear.

My tip: Be flexible. Don't get lost in the chaos. And always have a backup plan in your head.

Type 4: The "Free Hand, But There" Boss This is the good one. They trust you to do your job, give you space, and let you figure things out.

But if you hit a wall, they're right there to help. I once messed up big time, and instead of yelling, my boss just asked, "How can I help you fix this?" That's a game-changer.

My tip: If you find this boss, hold onto them! They help you grow without breathing down your neck.

Type 5: The "Big Picture" Boss This boss sees the future and makes you believe you can be part of it. They don't just tell you what to do; they show you how your work fits into something bigger. They inspire you and set you up to win.

My tip: Listen to their vision. They're not just giving you tasks; they're giving you a path to success.

The Real Deal

Here's what I've figured out: ***No boss is perfect. But every boss is like a mirror.***

They show us what we care about, what we'll put up with, and what kind of leader we want to be (or definitely *not* be). So, "the boss is always right" isn't about just saying yes. It's about learning—from the good, the bad, and the totally wild.

Your Turn: Let's Get This Going!

Which type have you worked with—and how did you handle it? Share your story, lessons, or just hit 👍 if you've ever had a boss who fits one of these types.

Let's share some real-world wisdom. Stay Curious, Vikas

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**Nitin Bawsay** ✓ • 1st
Growth Generalist

5mo ...

I'm sure that you've come across "the empathy boss". These guys are agile and really help you steer your career growth as the challenges come! In the current times, I'll go with them.

Would you too?

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**Vikas Surani** Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

Nitin Bawsay Great point, Nitin! The empathy boss is a game-changer, especially now. I'd definitely choose them too—nothing beats having a leader who truly supports your growth.

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**Anu Magaraju (Adriana Mathews)** ✓ • 1st
Building KEBS.ai! Helping organizations eliminate inefficiencies, b...

5mo ...

Really enjoyed this edition, such a relatable and honest breakdown of leadership styles. I've definitely worked with a mix of these, and your line "every boss is like a mirror" really hit home. Thanks for sharing this, looking forward to more!

Like | Reply · 1 reply

**Vikas Surani** Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

Anu Magaraju (Adriana Mathews) Thanks, Anu! So glad it resonated. That 'mirror' idea really came from years of reflection. Appreciate you reading & sharing your perspective!

**Ranjit Narula** • 1st
Senior Advisor to CXOs for Cloudification, Digitization & A...

(edited) 5mo ...

The best leader who is and remains great is **Vineet Nayar**. He did a great job of incorporating a 360 degree review of all managers. Managers were scared because every managers feedback was made public including his.

...more

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**Vikas Surani** Author
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5mo ...

Sanjay Naithani Great to hear that, Sanjay! Working with inspiring leaders really does make all the difference. Thanks for sharing your experience!

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